

9-Day Luxury Whitsundays Itinerary

Designed for a luxury traveller who loves diving, hiking, steak and seafood, with two built-in contingency days to reduce the impact of bad weather or cancellations.

Day	Main plan	Weather / cancellation backup
1 - Arrival	Arrive on Hamilton Island and check into qualia . Relax by the pool, enjoy the spa and have a sunset dinner.	No major activity scheduled, so travel delays have little impact.
2 - Diving	Great Barrier Reef scuba diving on a private or small-group charter. Prioritise this early in the trip so it can be rescheduled.	Move the dive to Day 5 or 8. Use the day for spa, resort dining and relaxation.
3 - Hiking	Hike Passage Peak , Hamilton Island's highest point. Spend the afternoon at the pool or beach, followed by a premium steak dinner.	Try a shorter walk such as Resort Lookout, or move the main hike to Day 7.
4 - Whitehaven	Take a private charter to Whitehaven Beach and Hill Inlet . Add snorkelling if sea conditions are suitable.	Reschedule to Day 5 or 8 and enjoy a long lunch, spa treatment and resort facilities.
5 - FLEX 1	Contingency day . Use it to repeat any cancelled dive, hike or Whitehaven trip. If nothing was cancelled, enjoy kayaking, paddleboarding or a private beach day.	The day is deliberately flexible.
6 - Diving	Second reef experience, ideally at a different dive site. A private charter provides greater comfort and flexibility.	Try a scenic flight if conditions permit, or enjoy an indoor/resort day.
7 - Hiking	Hike towards Escape Beach or Coral Cove , then spend the afternoon swimming and relaxing. Finish with a seafood-focused dinner.	Move the hike to Day 8 and use today as a resort day.
8 - FLEX 2	Second contingency day . Reschedule anything missed. If the trip has run smoothly, make this a full luxury day with spa, pool, private beach time and a long lunch.	No fixed activity means poor weather causes minimal disruption.
9 - Departure	Slow breakfast, final swim and check-out. Avoid booking an essential excursion or dive on departure day.	A relaxed schedule protects against minor delays.

Best base

Hamilton Island is the strongest base because it combines luxury accommodation, reef access, walking trails, restaurants and resort activities without requiring frequent transfers. **qualia** is the first-choice luxury stay; **Beach Club** is another strong option. For greater seclusion, **InterContinental Hayman** **Great Barrier Reef** is an alternative.

Food focus

Build dinners around premium **steak and local seafood**. Pebble Beach at qualia and Beach Club Restaurant fit the luxury style, while Mariners is a strong seafood option. Look for fresh fish, prawns and oysters, and choose premium beef dishes according to current seasonal menus.

Why this plan works

The two FLEX days act as trip insurance. The highest-priority weather-dependent activities - diving, Whitehaven Beach and hiking - are scheduled before the final day, creating multiple chances to reschedule. Pre-book important activities and restaurants with flexible cancellation or rescheduling terms wherever possible.